Acme Corporation — Leave Policy

Human Resources Policy Document · Version 1.0 · Effective January 1, 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

This Leave Policy outlines the types of leave available to employees of Acme Corporation ("the Company"), the eligibility requirements for each, and the process for requesting time away from work. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees, unless a specific section states otherwise.

Managers and employees are jointly responsible for planning leave in a way that minimizes disruption to business operations. Nothing in this policy overrides statutory leave entitlements in the employee's jurisdiction of employment; where local law provides greater benefits than this policy, local law applies.

2. Annual Leave (Vacation)

2.1 Accrual and Entitlement

Full-time employees accrue 15 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, credited monthly at a rate of 1.25 days per full month of service. Part-time employees accrue leave on a pro-rated basis according to their contracted hours.

New employees begin accruing leave from their first day of employment but may not take annual leave during their first 90 days, except with manager approval.

2.2 Requesting Leave

Employees must submit annual leave requests through the HR portal at least 10 business days in advance. Requests are approved at the manager's discretion, taking into account team workload and prior commitments.

- Requests of 5 consecutive working days or more require 4 weeks' notice.
- Leave taken around major public holidays may be subject to blackout periods communicated by the department head.
- Unapproved absences are treated as unauthorized leave and may be subject to disciplinary action.

2.3 Carryover and Forfeiture

Employees may carry over a maximum of 5 unused annual leave days into the following calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by March 31 of the new year, after which they are forfeited. Exceptions may be granted where an employee was unable to take leave due to approved extended sick leave or parental leave in the preceding year.

EXAMPLE

Priya has 4 unused vacation days on December 31. All 4 days carry over automatically. She must use them by March 31 or they will be forfeited, unless she was on approved medical leave during that window.

3. Sick Leave

3.1 Entitlement

Employees receive 10 paid sick days per calendar year. Unused sick days do not roll over to the following year and are not paid out upon termination.

3.2 Notification Requirements

Employees who are unable to work due to illness must notify their manager before their normal start time, or as soon as reasonably possible. Notification may be made by phone, email, or the messaging channel designated by the team.

3.3 Medical Certification

A doctor's note is required for any sick leave lasting more than 3 consecutive working days. HR reserves the right to request medical certification for shorter absences where a pattern of frequent short-term absence is observed.

3.4 Extended Illness

Employees facing a serious or long-term illness should contact HR to discuss extended sick leave, which may be granted beyond the standard 10-day entitlement on an unpaid or partially paid basis, subject to applicable disability or insurance benefits.

4. Parental Leave

4.1 Maternity and Primary Caregiver Leave

Employees who are the primary caregiver following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child are entitled to 12 weeks of paid parental leave. Leave may begin up to 2 weeks before the expected due date and must be taken within 12 months of the child's arrival.

4.2 Paternity and Secondary Caregiver Leave

Employees who are the secondary caregiver are entitled to 4 weeks of paid leave, which may be taken continuously or split into two blocks within the first 6 months following the child's arrival, subject to

manager approval of scheduling.

4.3 Adoption and Foster Leave

Adoptive and foster parents are eligible for the same entitlements as biological parents described above, calculated from the date the child is placed with the family rather than the date of birth.

4.4 Returning to Work

Employees returning from parental leave are guaranteed reinstatement to their same or an equivalent role, with no loss of seniority. Employees who wish to request a phased return or flexible schedule should discuss this with HR at least 2 weeks before their return date.

> **EXAMPLE**
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> *Daniel takes 4 weeks of secondary caregiver leave after his partner gives birth, splitting it into 2 weeks immediately after the birth and 2 weeks three months later, both approved in advance by his manager.*

5. Sabbatical Leave

5.1 Eligibility

Employees with at least 5 years of continuous service are eligible to apply for unpaid sabbatical leave of up to 3 months. Sabbatical leave is granted at the discretion of senior management and is not guaranteed.

5.2 Application Process

Applications must be submitted to HR at least 3 months in advance, outlining the intended dates, purpose, and a handover plan for ongoing responsibilities. HR and the employee's manager will respond within 4 weeks of submission.

5.3 Pay and Benefits During Sabbatical

Sabbatical leave is unpaid. Health insurance benefits continue during the sabbatical period, with the employee responsible for any portion of premiums normally deducted from payroll. Annual leave and sick leave do not accrue during a sabbatical.

6. Other Leave Types

6.1 Bereavement Leave

Employees are entitled to 5 paid days of bereavement leave following the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling), and 2 paid days for the death of an extended family member.

6.2 Jury Duty and Civic Leave

Employees summoned for jury duty or required to appear in court as a witness will be granted paid leave for the duration of their service, upon presentation of the official summons to HR.

6.3 Unpaid Personal Leave

Employees who have exhausted other applicable leave types may request unpaid personal leave of up to 4 weeks per calendar year, subject to manager and HR approval based on business needs.

6.4 Public Holidays

The Company observes 10 paid public holidays per year, as published annually on the HR portal. Employees required to work on a public holiday will receive a substitute day off within 30 days or premium pay, per local requirements.

7. General Provisions

7.1 Leave Approval Process

All leave requests, regardless of type, are submitted and tracked through the HR portal. Verbal approval from a manager does not replace the need for a formal request record.

7.2 Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually by HR and may be updated to reflect changes in employment law or business needs. Employees will be notified of material changes at least 30 days before they take effect.